Nerd Nite Fort Collins

Be there and be square

You Had to be There

PHOTO img/p01-room

The Fort Collins room mid-talk, audience faces lit by the screen. The room is the subject, not the speaker.

Justin Fritz

Boss, Nerd Nite Fort Collins

Hi. I'm Justin Fritz.

And I'm a Nerd Nite Boss.

That is a real title. They gave it to me. I take it very seriously.

PHOTO img/p02-justin

Justin at the NNFC mic, mid-sentence, hands moving. A frame grab off a show video beats anything posed.

I have had a lot of roles

Marine • navigator • instructor

chip designer • founder • host

As an American, I tend to conflate
the person with the job.

Tonight I am here as myself.
And as a Nerd Nite boss.



The relevant education

Not the classrooms.

In the field.

In the lab.

Frankly — at Nerd Nites.

PHOTO img/p04-field

One image for "the field or the lab" - a bench, a flight deck, a probe card, anything with his hands in it. Candid and specific beats illustrative.



PHOTO

img/p03-trajectories

Many separate tracks arriving at one point. Hand-drawn pencil lines on a chart, or long-exposure light trails. Flown, not plotted – not a tidy infographic.

Trajectories

Everything I just listed is a sampling of one trajectory.

Everyone in this room has a rich history.

Tonight ours came together here.

Thank you.



Talks. Mars. An abstract. An organ.



“You had to be there.”

the thing people say when the telling failed



Worst Party Ever

Everything You Didn’t Know About the Donner Party

Hannah Bauer

NNFC S2025E01 30 January 2025

Nobody in that bar was in the Sierra Nevada in 1846.

For a moment they were.

PHOTO img/p05-donner

Hannah on stage at the Wolverine with her own Donner slide behind her – ideally mid-laugh, or the room mid-laugh. Second choice: her S2025E01 poster art.

Hector Berlioz Was a Visionary Composer and also a Creepy Stalker

Matt Browne

NNFC S2024E04 April 2024



Why did that just work?



PHOTO

img/p06-mars

A rover alone on Mars, empty horizon, no people and no Earth in frame. The emptiness is the argument - pick the loneliest public-domain NASA/JPL frame available.

We have not sent people

We sent probes. Rovers. Instruments.

They returned more data than anyone can read.

Somebody had a hypothesis before it ever launched.

Somebody else is reading it back.



The telemetry is complete.

The chronicle is not.



Worm Majix

John Anderson

NNFC S2025E08 18 September 2025

The abstract arrived rough.

Jamie started to fix it.

I stopped her.

We ran it exactly as offered.

PHOTO img/p07-john

John at the Wolverine, dressed exactly as he dresses for any other evening there, talking with his hands. The slide is the man, never the paragraph.

PHOTO

img/p08-organ-build

Hands. Audience members at tables with organ parts spread out, mid-assembly. Faces optional, hands mandatory.

Let’s Build a Pipe Organ!

Joel Bacon

NNFC S2026E06 18 June 2026

Hundreds of parts.

Two octaves. Hand pumped. Mechanical action.

The audience built it.

Then he played it

A hand-pumped organ cannot make a sound unless somebody is standing there supplying the air.

We needed a volunteer.

Somebody put their hand up.

PHOTO img/p09-organ-play

Joel at the keyboard AND the volunteer on the pump handle, both in one frame. Without the volunteer visible this beat loses its evidence. This is the most important photo in the deck.